

Positive mental health

Mental health is a person's emotional and social self, their inner well-being. People look after their physical health through exercising, and by eating and sleeping well. It's just as important to take time to look after their mental health, too.

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Feeling positive

Positive mental health consists of four main elements: the ability to recognize emotions, dealing with those emotions, practicing healthy mental habits, and establishing strong support networks. When a person has these four things in place, it is easier to feel mentally positive. And when someone feels mentally positive, they are able to live life to their full potential while handling any hurdles and hiccups that life sends their way.

PARENT TIPS

Supporting your teen

- Talk to your teen about the qualities you admire in them, such as their thoughtfulness toward friends and family.
- Model thoughtfulness for your teen. When you are frustrated, talk about how it makes you feel and the positive steps you plan to take to resolve the issue.
- Encourage your teen to take time do things they enjoy, even during exam time. This will prevent them from getting overwhelmed, which will help their performance.

A healthy mind

Even if a person feels on top of the world, it's important that they take time to do something for their inner well-being. When a person is mentally healthy, they're aware of what makes them feel positive and what gets them down. Paying attention to their mental health helps teens to become better equipped to acknowledge what they're feeling and to keep a balanced perspective on both life and themselves.

Appreciate your talents

When a person takes time to acknowledge and appreciate their own talents and accomplishments, it can help ward off negative thoughts and feelings, such as not feeling good enough or comparing their own achievements with those of others. Everyone is different, with their own unique talents and ways of doing things. Acknowledging that can help teens to celebrate their own.

Attempt mindfulness

Mindfulness is a technique that encourages a person to focus their attention on the present moment, and to their immediate thoughts and feelings. By acknowledging each individual thought, they stop feeling down or overwhelmed. This gives them a sense of control. Breathing exercises help with mindfulness.

► Positive thinking strategies

There are many ways to build positive mental health—in good times and bad.